

IDS11074
Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia Gulf Waters

Issued at 3:40 am CST on Thursday 1 October 2026
for the period until midnight CST Saturday 3 October 2026.

Please be aware

Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A series of slow moving troughs will move across the state today as a cold front moves across waters to the south. A high pressure system will become established south of the Bight during Friday and persist there on Saturday. A trough will extend from WA over the far west of SA over the weekend.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Thursday 1 October until midnight

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming southerly 10 to 15 knots in the middle of the day. Winds reaching up to 20 knots north of Cowell to Wallaroo in the afternoon. Seas: Below 0.5 metres, increasing to around 1 metre during the afternoon. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Cloudy. 95% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm.

Forecast for Friday 2 October

Winds: Southwesterly 15 to 20 knots turning southerly during the morning and early afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy. 70% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm south of Port Neill to Port Victoria in the morning.

Forecast for Saturday 3 October

Winds: Southerly 15 to 20 knots turning southeasterly 10 to 15 knots during the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres north of Cowell to Wallaroo during the afternoon or evening. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Thursday 1 October until midnight

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming southerly 10 to 15 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Cloudy. Near 100% chance of rain. The chance of a thunderstorm during this afternoon and evening.

Forecast for Friday 2 October

Winds: Southerly about 10 knots increasing to 15 to 20 knots in the early morning. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres in the eastern waters around midday. Swell: South to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning and afternoon.

Forecast for Saturday 3 October

Winds: Southerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southeast to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Central Coast

Forecast for Thursday 1 October until midnight

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming southerly 10 to 15 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 80% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm later tonight.

Forecast for Friday 2 October

Winds: South to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots tending south to southeasterly during the day. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning.

Forecast for Saturday 3 October

Winds: Southeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Thursday 1 October until midnight

Winds: East to northeasterly below 10 knots becoming south to southeasterly in the middle of the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Cloudy. 90% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm late this afternoon and evening.

Forecast for Friday 2 October

Winds: Southerly about 10 knots increasing to 15 to 20 knots before dawn. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres through the Backstairs Passage during the afternoon. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres around midday. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning.

Forecast for Saturday 3 October

Winds: Southerly 15 to 20 knots turning southeasterly 10 to 15 knots during the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres through the Backstairs Passage. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to around 1 metre during the afternoon or evening. Weather: Partly cloudy.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 9:30 am CST Thursday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

Check the latest Coastal Waters Forecasts for information on wind, wave and weather conditions for neighbouring coastal zones.